

Injin Kong

M.S. Student, Graduate School of Data Science, Seoul National University
Advisor: Yohan Jo

Email: mtkong77@snu.ac.kr
Mobile: +82-10-6243-2892
Seoul, Republic of Korea

PERSONAL DATA

- **Nationality:** Republic of Korea
- **Language:** Native Korean, professional working proficiency in English

EDUCATION

- **Seoul National University** Seoul, Korea
M.S. in Data Science March 2025 - Present
Advisor: Yohan Jo
Research Areas: Large Language Models, Mechanistic Interpretability, Diffusion Language Models, Multimodal Reasoning
- **Seoul National University** Seoul, Korea
B.S. in Mathematics March 2020 - February 2025

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- **Mechanistic Interpretability, Language Models, Diffusion Language Models, Multimodal Reasoning, and AI Agents**
 - Mechanistic interpretability of large language models
 - Autoregressive and diffusion-based language modeling
 - Representation learning and style extraction from text embeddings
 - Value expression, alignment, and internal mechanisms in LLMs
 - Multimodal reasoning, visual persuasion, and rationale faithfulness
 - AI agents and retrieval-augmented generation systems

PUBLICATIONS

*: Equal contribution

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- Jongwook Han, Jongwon Lim, **Injin Kong**, and Yohan Jo, “Dual Mechanisms of Value Expression: Intrinsic vs. Prompted Values in Large Language Models,” International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2026.
- **Injin Kong**, Hyoungjoon Lee, and Yohan Jo, “Where Should Diffusion Enter a Language Model? Geometry-Guided Hidden-State Replacement,” ICML 2026 Workshop on Foundation Generative Models (FoGen), 2026.

Preprints and Manuscripts

- Naeun Lee, Hyunjong Kim, Sunghwan Choi, **Injin Kong**, and Yohan Jo, “Can MLLMs Reason About Visual Persuasion? Evaluating the Efficacy and Faithfulness of Reasoning,” arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.08965, 2026.
- **Injin Kong***, Hyoungjoon Lee*, and Yohan Jo, “Mechanism Shift During Post-training from Autoregressive to Masked Diffusion Language Models,” arXiv preprint arXiv:2601.14758, 2026.
- **Injin Kong**, Shinyee Kang, Yuna Park, Sooyong Kim, and Sanghyun Park, “Style Extraction on Text Embeddings Using VAE and Parallel Dataset,” arXiv preprint arXiv:2502.08668, 2025.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

- **Graduate Researcher, Seoul National University** March 2025 - Present
Graduate School of Data Science, advised by Yohan Jo
Conducting research on mechanistic interpretability, value expression in LLMs, diffusion language models, and multimodal reasoning. Current projects analyze how internal representations and circuits change across prompting, post-training, and multimodal rationale generation.
- **Research on Diffusion Language Models** 2025 - Present
Mechanism analysis of autoregressive and masked diffusion language models
Studied how post-training autoregressive models into masked diffusion models changes internal computation. Analyzed whether diffusion post-training preserves autoregressive circuits or induces new mechanisms for non-sequential and global planning tasks.

Research on Value Mechanisms in LLMs Intrinsic and prompted value expression in large language models Investigated how LLMs express values through intrinsic model behavior and explicit prompting. Contributed to mechanistic analyses using value directions and value-related neurons to compare steerability, response diversity, and instruction-following effects.	2025 - 2026
Research on Visual Persuasion Reasoning in MLLMs Rationale supervision and faithfulness evaluation for multimodal reasoning Studied whether MLLMs can reason faithfully about visual persuasiveness. Contributed to a framework evaluating rationale-to-decision consistency, rationale-to-image groundedness, and rationale-to-decision sensitivity.	2026 - Present
Research on Style Extraction from Text Embeddings VAE-based analysis of style distributions in parallel text data Developed a VAE-based approach for separating and analyzing stylistic variation in text embeddings using parallel Bible translations. Studied how style can be represented as distributions in embedding space and applied to AI-based text generation and style analysis.	2024 - 2025

ENTREPRENEURIAL AND INDUSTRY EXPERIENCES

Aardvark Co-Founder and Chief Scientific Officer, AI EdTech Startup Built AI systems for generating English test questions, including data construction, retrieval, model prompting, and evaluation pipelines. Led research and product development for LLM-based educational content generation.	November 2023 - August 2025
BLACKLABEL Geometry Mathematics Content Reviewer, Jinhaksa Reviewed advanced geometry problems for high-achieving students in <i>BLACKLABEL Geometry</i>, a mathematics workbook based on the 2015 revised Korean national curriculum.	2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Computing 1 Seoul National University	2025
---	------

ACADEMIC SERVICES

- Reviewer, ICML 2026 Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment

HONORS AND AWARDS

Second Place, CJ Logistics Future Technology Challenge	2023
Academic Excellence Award (Highest Academic Achievement), Yonsei University	2019
Gold Prize, Korean Mathematical Olympiad (KMO)	2018
Grand Prize (1st Place), Earth Science Competition, Hana Academy Seoul	2018
Gold Prize (2nd Place), Mathematics Research Presentation Contest, Hana Academy Seoul	2018